

HealthPlus Insurance — Pharmacy Prior Authorization Department

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION REQUEST FORM — BIOLOGIC / SPECIALTY DRUG

SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT — FOR DEMONSTRATION ONLY — CONTAINS NO REAL PATIENT DATA

Patient: Nancy J. Whitfield	DOB: 04/05/1970	MRN: 7723019
Date: Submitted: October 18, 2024		Provider: Dr. Omar Haddad, MD — Rheumatology, Westside Arthritis Center

REQUEST INFORMATION

Drug Requested:	Adalimumab (Humira) 40mg subcutaneous injection every 2 weeks	Quantity:	2 prefilled syringes per 28-day supply
Duration Requested:	12 months, then renewal review	Diagnosis (Primary):	Rheumatoid arthritis, seropositive (ICD-10: M05.9)
Diagnosis (Secondary):	Erosive disease confirmed on hand/wrist X-ray; functional impairment (HAQ-DI 1.6)	Plan / Member ID:	HealthPlus PPO Gold / HP-09937412
NPI:	1245631092 (Haddad, Omar MD)	Pharmacy:	Specialty Rx Partners, NCPDP 2940128

CLINICAL JUSTIFICATION

Ms. Whitfield is a 54-year-old female with a 6-year history of seropositive rheumatoid arthritis (RF positive 82 IU/mL, anti-CCP positive 148 U/mL). She presents with ongoing polyarthritis affecting bilateral MCP, PIP, and wrist joints with morning stiffness lasting >1 hour. DAS28-CRP is 5.1 (high disease activity). Recent hand/wrist radiographs demonstrate progressive erosive changes at the 2nd and 3rd MCP joints bilaterally, indicating structural damage progression.

The patient has failed to achieve adequate disease control despite multiple prior therapies as documented below. Given persistent high disease activity with erosive disease, initiating biologic therapy with an anti-TNF agent (adalimumab) per ACR 2021 RA management guidelines is medically necessary.

STEP THERAPY DOCUMENTATION

Drug	Duration	Outcome	Stopped Date
Methotrexate 20mg/wk	18 months	Partial response;	April 2023
Hydroxychloroquine 400mg/	12 months (add-on)	Inadequate response; DAS28	March 2024
Leflunomide 20mg/day	8 months	GI intolerance (nausea, diarrhea grade 2); discontinued	October 2024

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTATION

TB Screening:	QuantiFERON Gold negative — October 10, 2024	Hepatitis B:	HBsAg negative, Anti-HBs positive (immune) — on file
Varicella Immunity:	IgG positive — on file	Contraindications:	None identified (no active infection, no demyelinating disease, no CHF)
Attached Records:	Rheumatology clinic notes x3, lab results, radiograph reports — uploaded to portal	Prescriber Signature:	Omar Haddad, MD — signed electronically October 18, 2024

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